Buffalo Gals



You may remember George Bailey serenading Mary under the light of a full moon. What you may not know is that wooing under the full moon was a tradition in the Bailey family. And it was a very particular tradition – the moon must be full or else the importuning was doomed to failure. Pa Bailey warned George: "New moon contempt, our family curse." And George warned his brother Harry: "Half-moon dismay, our family bane." To be sure, they were all quick to give thanks when a full moon appeared at an opportune moment, but what they feared most was a moon that was almost full, that could lead them into error. They warned each other: "Gibbous disdain, our Bailey dread."